# Dylan Cease

TOR · RHP · Starter · Age 30 · 2,896 pitches · 29 G

**Pitcher evaluation**
2026 regular season
Data through **2026-09-27**
MLBAM 656302

| IP | ERA | FIP | XFIP | XERA | K% | BB% | K-BB% | CSW% | WHIFF% | CHASE% | FB VELO |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 169.0 | 2.40 | 2.56 | 2.92 | 2.92 | 34.9% | 11.4% | 23.5% | 29.8% | 30.4% | 31.7% | 96.8 |

## BOTTOM LINE

1. **Best pitch: changeup (60 Stuff / 70 Results):** 45.2% whiff, .195 xwOBA, 11% usage; only 11% of 2K pitches — room to lean on it to finish.
2. **Primary FB velo down 2.4 mph** over his last 5 games (94.9 vs 97.3 baseline); IL from Sep 20 (right shoulder inflammation) — verify health/mechanics before projecting.
3. **Elite run prevention by xERA:** 2.40 ERA, 2.92 xERA (91st pct), 2.56 FIP, 23.5% K-BB.
4. **Underused changeup (70 Results):** .195 xwOBA, 45% whiff, RV/100 +1.0 on only 11% usage (19% vs LHH / 1% vs RHH).
5. **Plus-plus bat-missing (70):** 34.9% K, 30.4% whiff/swing (94th pct), 29.8% CSW.

## 20–80 GRADES

vs 424 pitchers ≥600 pitches

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Stuff** | 65 | +0.45 RV/100 |
| **Command** | 40 | BB 11.4% |
| **Bat-missing** | 70 | Whiff 30% |
| **Contact mgmt** | 55 | xwOBAcon .341 |
| **Durability** | 75 | IP/GS 5.8 |

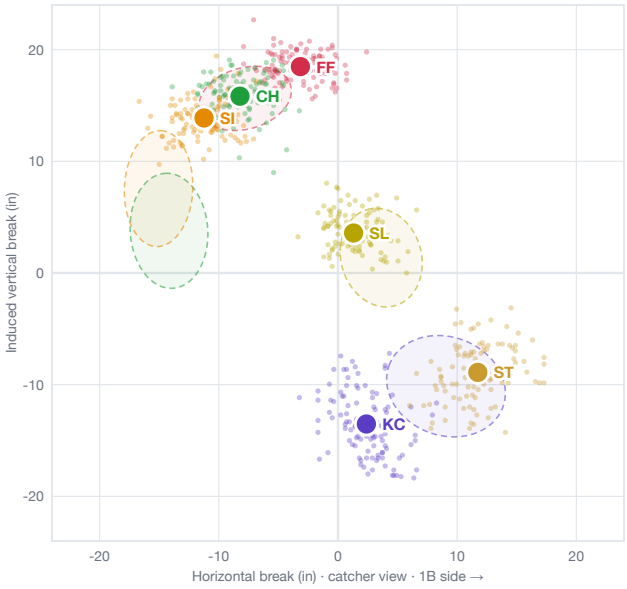
## ARSENAL Arsenal — four-seam is the best pitch by shape (65 Stuff, plus)

Velo mph · spin rpm · IVB/HB inches, catcher view (HB + = toward 1B) · Ext ft · Whiff per swing · Chase = swing % outside zone · xwOBA per PA ended · RV/100 = count-neutral run value per 100 pitches, + = good for pitcher · cells tinted by percentile within pitch type & hand · grey rows: n < 100

| | USAGE | | | | USAGE BY COUNT | | | | SHAPE | | | | | RESULTS | | | | | GRADES (20–80) | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| PITCH | N | ALL | VL | VR | 0-0 | AHD | BHD | 2K | VELO | SPIN | IVB | HB | EXT | WHIFF | CHASE | CSW | XWOBA | RV/100 | STUFF | RES | CMD |
| **Four-seam** FF | 1071 | **37%** | 38% | 35% | 36% | 34% | 40% | 38% | 96.8 | 2457 | 18.5 | -3.2 | 6.4 | 21% | 32% | 26% | .307 | +0.9 | 65 | 55 | 45 |
| **Slider** SL | 871 | **30%** | 25% | 38% | 21% | 32% | 34% | 37% | 88.7 | 2706 | 3.6 | 1.3 | 6.4 | 42% | 43% | 35% | .218 | +2.8 | 65 | 65 | 50 |
| **Changeup** CH | 332 | **11%** | 19% | 1% | 9% | 14% | 9% | 11% | 81.4 | 1739 | 15.8 | -8.2 | 6.6 | 45% | 17% | 29% | .195 | +1.0 | 60 | 70 | 45 |
| **Knuckle curve** KC | 292 | **10%** | 12% | 7% | 21% | 8% | 7% | 5% | 81.7 | 2664 | -13.5 | 2.4 | 6.4 | 29% | 17% | 32% | .305 | -0.5 | 35 | 50 | 40 |
| **Sinker** SI | 228 | **8%** | 5% | 11% | 8% | 8% | 8% | 7% | 95.8 | 2394 | 13.9 | -11.2 | 6.4 | 12% | 30% | 25% | .326 | +0.7 | 50 | 55 | 65 |
| **Sweeper** ST | 101 | **3%** | 1% | 8% | 6% | 4% | 2% | 2% | 83.4 | 2832 | -8.9 | 11.7 | 6.3 | 23% | 24% | 33% | .237 | -1.1 | 40 | 50 | 40 |

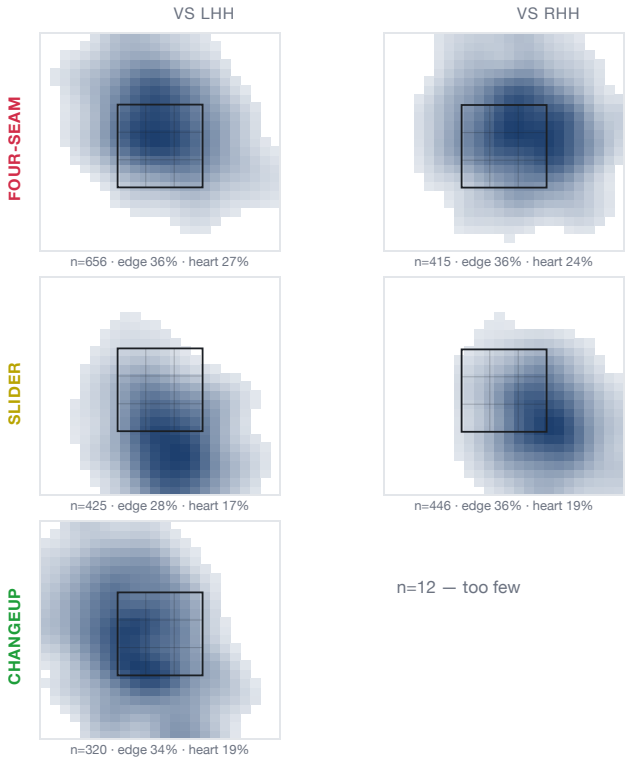
## SHAPE Movement — four-seam carries 2.8 in more IVB than the average RHP four-seam

Dots = individual pitches (≤110 per type); large markers = his averages; dashed ellipses = league 1-SD shape for the same pitch type from RHPs. Inches, catcher view.




## LOCATION Location — 56% of his four-seams finish in the upper third or above

Smoothed density of pitch locations (catcher view; box = average rule-book zone, thirds marked). Darker = more frequent (frequency, not quality) · edge = within ±3 in of the zone border.



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TOR · RHP · 2026 · through **2026-09-27**

## COUNTS Count strategy — most predictable in 2-0 vs RHH (56% four-seam)

Throws most = his most-used pitch in each count (tint: red = mixed, blue = ≥70% one pitch, i.e. predictable). Model pick = lowest expected xwOBA from the situational model vs a league-average hitter (◆ = differs). Mix gap = his actual mix's model xwOBA minus the model pick's, in points (.001); blue = larger opportunity.

| VS LHH | 0-0 | 1-0 | 2-0 | 3-0 | 0-1 | 1-1 | 2-1 | 3-1 | 0-2 | 1-2 | 2-2 | 3-2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Throws most | FF 43% n=402 | FF 34% n=157 | SL 42% n=57 | FF 86% n=21 | FF 38% n=209 | FF 34% n=173 | SL 40% n=93 | FF 48% n=31 | FF 38% n=117 | SL 30% n=175 | SL 31% n=161 | FF 44% n=126 |
| Model pick | FF | FF | SL | SL ◆ | FF | FF | FF ◆ | SL ◆ | FF | FF ◆ | FF ◆ | SL ◆ |
| Mix gap (pts) | 5 | 7 | 3 | 4 | 15 | 11 | 7 | 19 | 14 | 15 | 10 | 5 |

| VS RHH | 0-0 | 1-0 | 2-0 | 3-0 | 0-1 | 1-1 | 2-1 | 3-1 | 0-2 | 1-2 | 2-2 | 3-2 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Throws most | SL 32% n=288 | SL 44% n=107 | FF 56% n=36 | FF 93% n=15 | SL 41% n=145 | FF 35% n=111 | SL 48% n=65 | FF 45% n=29 | SL 49% n=79 | SL 42% n=125 | FF 45% n=96 | FF 55% n=77 |
| Model pick | FF ◆ | FF ◆ | SL ◆ | SL ◆ | FF ◆ | FF | FF ◆ | SL ◆ | FF ◆ | FF ◆ | FF | SL ◆ |
| Mix gap (pts) | 6 | 5 | 3 | 3 | 19 | 11 | 8 | 20 | 14 | 13 | 7 | 2 |

### MOST PREDICTABLE

2-0 vs RHH · **56% FF** n=36
3-2 vs RHH · **55% FF** n=77
0-2 vs RHH · **49% SL** n=79

### LARGEST MODEL GAPS

0-1 vs RHH · SL 41% → **FF** .285→.263
1-2 vs LHH · SL 30% → **FF** .277→.260
1-2 vs RHH · SL 42% → **FF** .276→.257

## SEQUENCE Sequencing — FF/CH is the best tunnel pair (6.3× separation after the decision point)

Share (%) of next pitch within the same PA, by previous pitch. Tunnel = mean trajectories 23.8 ft from the plate vs at the plate.

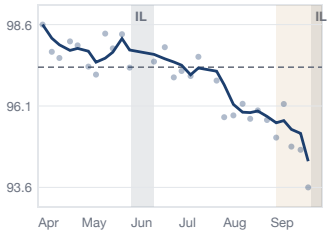
| AFTER ↓ / NEXT → | FF | SL | CH | KC | SI | ST |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| FF n=802 | 43 | 29 | 11 | 9 | 5 | 2 |
| SL n=633 | 33 | 42 | 10 | 3 | 9 | 3 |
| CH n=264 | 33 | 33 | 16 | 8 | 8 | 2 |
| KC n=259 | 33 | 25 | 22 | 8 | 9 | 3 |
| SI n=162 | 44 | 33 | 4 | 6 | 7 | 6 |
| ST n=84 | 31 | 36 | 10 | 2 | 17 | 5 |

Best tunnel: **FF/CH** — 1.4 in apart at the decision point, 8.8 in apart at the plate (6.3× late separation; release 1.2 in apart)
Slider after CH: **59% whiff** vs 42% overall (46 swings)
Four-seam after SL: **26% whiff** vs 21% overall (115 swings)

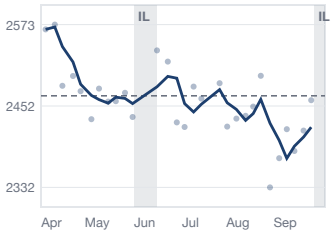
## TRENDS Trends — primary FB velo down 2.4 mph over his last 5 games

Per game (dots), 3-game rolling mean (line), dashed = baseline before last 5 games; ⚑ shaded = flagged window (≥1 mph, 75 rpm or 0.2 ft). Grey = IL: May 25–Jun 9 (Left hamstring strain); Sep 20–Sep 28 (Right shoulder inflammation).

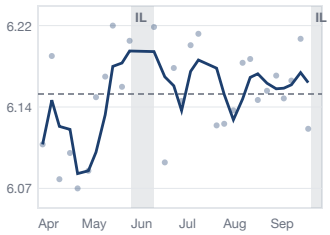
**Primary FB velo (mph) ⚑ -2.4 last 5**



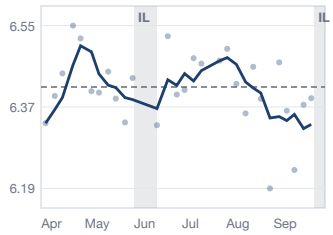

**Primary FB spin (rpm)**




**Release height (ft)**




**Extension (ft)**




## SPLITS Splits — even platoon profile (0-pt xwOBA gap)

Statcast PAs, regular season. xwOBA tint vs league .315 (red = better for him). Times through order use the batter's PA count vs this pitcher in the game. Velo hold: primary FB +1.2 mph on pitches 76+ vs 1–25. Grey rows: < 60 PA.

| SPLIT | PA | WOBA | XWOBA | K% | BB% | HR | WHIFF | CHASE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **vs LHH** | 396 | .252 | .265 | 36.4% | 11.6% | 8 | 30% | 31% |
| **vs RHH** | 286 | .270 | .265 | 33.2% | 11.2% | 3 | 30% | 33% |
| **1st time** | 261 | .249 | .272 | 37.2% | 11.5% | 5 | 33% | 32% |
| **2nd time** | 258 | .225 | .230 | 36.8% | 9.3% | 2 | 30% | 32% |
| **3rd+ time** | 163 | .330 | .312 | 28.8% | 14.7% | 4 | 26% | 31% |

## COMPS Comps — closest arsenal profile: Chase Burns

Nearest neighbors among qualified pitchers on pitch mix, primary-FB velo/IVB/HB, arm angle, breaking-ball shape and separation, whiff% and zone% (standardized, weighted). Chip = comp's Stuff grade.

**Chase Burns CIN** 75 — 69% similar
RHP SP · FB 97.6 mph, 19" IVB · FF 55% / SL 39%

**Tarik Skubal** 55 — 56% similar
LHP SP · FB 96.8 mph, 17" IVB · FF 38% / CH 26% / SI 17% / SL 14%

**Mason Montgomery PIT** 65 — 56% similar
LHP RP · FB 98.5 mph, 18" IVB · FF 46% / SI 24% / SL 14% / CU 13%

## DEVELOP Development notes — usage direction from the arsenal optimizer

Constrained optimizer on the outcome model (each pitch ±15 pts, 3–55% bounds). Expected gains are small and model-dependent: hypotheses for the pitching staff, not prescriptions.

**vs LHH:** FF 38→23%, SL 25→40%, CH 19→30% (model xwOBA -3 pts, n=1722)
**vs RHH:** SL 38→53%, FF 35→20%, ST 8→20% (model xwOBA -6 pts, n=1173)
**Shape:** his knuckle curve grades 35 Stuff. Top-quartile RHP curveballs average 19.8 in of horizontal separation from the fastball vs his 5.5 — the largest gap; worth a look in pitch design, not a prescription.

**Grades.** each scale is a z-score composite converted to a percentile within the qualified pool, then 50 + 10·Φ⁻¹(p), clipped 20–80 and shown to the nearest 5. Pitch grades are within the same pitch type and throwing hand (≥100 pitches). Stuff = a gradient-boosted model of expected, count-neutral run value from velo, movement, spin, extension, release, arm angle and separation from the primary fastball (no location or results; held-out pitch-type correlation r=0.36). Results = whiff%, CSW%, xwOBA. Command = edge%, waste%, heart% (pitch) and BB%, edge, zone, first-strike (overall). Durability = IP/start, pitches/game, late-game velo hold (relievers: G, IP). **Models.** count plan = situational pitch-type model (2026, generic league-average hitter, medium leverage, 2nd time through); location/tunneling from Statcast trajectory fits at a 23.8 ft decision point; usage suggestion = constrained arsenal optimizer (±15 pts/pitch). Model gaps are small effects — treat as direction. **Caveats.** single season, regular season only; small-sample cells greyed; xwOBA ignores park and defense; IL dates from MLB transactions (retroactive dates honored).